

AoE2 Tournament Agent

Player Guide

Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition — Community Tournament

Everything you need to register, play your matches, and compete in your division — step by step.

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1. How the Tournament Works (Quick Overview)

Phase	What Happens	Your Action
Register	Create your account on the tournament website	Fill in the registration form
Placement Games	Play 5 games to determine your ELO and division	Play matches, report results
Pay Entry Fee	Pay two PayPal fees to join the bracket	Click Pay via PayPal buttons in your portal
Wait for Confirmation	Organiser checks PayPal and confirms receipt	Click "I've Paid Both Fees"
Settings Vote	Vote on map, resources, and speed for your division	Vote in your portal
Swiss Bracket	7 rounds of play against players at your skill level	Play matches, report results
Top 8 Playoff	Top 8 finishers play a single-elimination final	Play and report if you qualify
Champion	Division winner is crowned, prizes distributed	Win the Grand Final

Placement games are completely free. You only pay the entry fee once your placement games are done and you are assigned to a division. Your payment status must show "Received" before you can enter the bracket.

2. Step 1 — Register Your Account

- 1 Open the tournament URL in your browser (shared in your Discord server).
- 2 Click the **Register** button on the home page.
- 3 Fill in all the fields:

Field	What to Enter
Player Name	Your in-game name or nickname
Discord Tag	Your full Discord tag (e.g. TheViper#1337)
Email Address	Your email — used to log in. Must be real and unique.
Password	Choose a password (minimum 6 characters)
Confirm Password	Type your password again to confirm
Favourite Civ	Your preferred civilization (shown on your profile)
Known ELO	Your current ELO if you know it. Leave at 800 if unsure.
Timezone	Your timezone — match times will show in your local time

- 1 Click **Create Account**.
- 2 A success screen appears. Click **Log In Now**.

Use your real email. This is your login and how the organiser may contact you. If you forget your password, contact the tournament organiser to reset it.

3. Step 2 — Log Into Your Portal

- 1 Click **Login** in the navigation bar.
- 2 Enter your email address and password.
- 3 Click **Sign In** (or press Enter).
- 4 You are now in your player portal.

Your portal has four tabs:

Tab	What It Shows
Dashboard	Your stats, pending matches with lobby info, settings vote, placement progress
My Matches	All your upcoming and completed matches. Report results here.
Standings	Your division's Swiss standings with your position highlighted
Profile	Your account details and fee payment status

Bookmark the tournament URL. You will come back here to check your next match, report results, and track standings throughout the tournament.

4. Step 3 — Your Placement Matches

After the organiser closes registration and generates the schedule, your placement matches will appear in your portal dashboard.

Each placement match shows you:

- 1 Your opponent's name, ELO, and timezone
- 2 The scheduled date and time **in your local timezone**
- 3 The lobby name and password
- 4 All game settings (map, resources, speed, spectator delay)

You need to complete **5 placement matches** to be assigned to your division. After each match, both players report the result from their portals.

Contact your opponent on Discord if you need to reschedule. Coordinate the new time between yourselves, then play at that time. The scheduled time is a suggestion — what matters is that you play all 5 matches.

5. How to Set Up a Game Lobby

Player 1 creates the lobby. Player 2 joins. The lobby box in your portal shows who creates.

- 1 Open Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition.
- 2 Click **Multiplayer** → **Create Game**.
- 3 Set the game settings exactly as shown in your lobby box (map, resources, speed, game mode).
- 4 In the lobby name field, type the exact lobby name shown (e.g. **NA-KINGS-R01-THEVvCLAN**).
- 5 Set the lobby password exactly as shown (e.g. **castle42**).
- 6 **IMPORTANT: Set spectator delay to at least 10 minutes** before making the lobby public.
- 7 Enable **Record Game** in the game settings.
- 8 Create the lobby and wait for your opponent to join.

Player 2 joins:

- 1 Click Multiplayer → Join Game.
- 2 Search for the lobby name shown in your portal.
- 3 Enter the lobby password when prompted.
- 4 Check the game settings match what was shown in the portal.

Recording is required. Both players must enable Record Game before starting. If there is a dispute, the recording is the only way to resolve it.

6. Game Settings for Placement Matches

Use the settings shown in your portal lobby box. Default placement match settings are:

Setting	Default Value	Notes
Map	Random Map	Game picks randomly — standard and fair
Starting Resources	Standard	Normal starting resources
Game Speed	Normal	Standard competitive speed
Game Mode	Random Map	Standard 1v1 mode
Spectator Delay	10 minutes minimum	REQUIRED — set this in lobby settings
Recording	Required	Enable before starting the game

If your tournament has different settings, they will be shown in your lobby box. Always use what the lobby box says — not the defaults above.

7. Step 4 — Reporting a Result

After finishing a match, both players report the result from their portal:

- 1 Log into your portal at the tournament URL.
- 2 Go to **My Portal** → **Dashboard** or **My Matches** tab.
- 3 Find the match you just played.
- 4 Click **I Won** if you won, or **I Lost** if you lost.
- 5 The app records your report and waits for your opponent to confirm.

Both players must report. If only you report, the match shows 'Waiting for opponent to confirm.' Your opponent needs to log in and report their result too.

8. What Happens When Both Players Agree

When both players report the same winner:

- 1 The result is **automatically confirmed** — no admin needed.
- 2 ELO ratings are updated for both players.
- 3 For placement matches: placement progress bar advances.
- 4 For tournament matches: standings are updated immediately.
- 5 The match shows a gold trophy and the winner's name.

This is the normal flow. Most matches resolve in seconds once both players report. You don't need to wait for an admin.

9. What Happens If Results Don't Match (Dispute)

If you report one winner and your opponent reports a different winner, a **dispute** is created.

- 1 The match turns red with a ■■ DISPUTED label.
- 2 The tournament admin is notified automatically.
- 3 Both players should **immediately save their game recording** if they haven't already.
- 4 Wait for the admin to contact you and request the recording.
- 5 Send your recording to the admin (via Discord, Google Drive, etc.).
- 6 The admin reviews both recordings and picks the correct winner.
- 7 The result is confirmed and the match is resolved.

Always record your games. If you don't have a recording and there is a dispute, the decision will most likely go against you.

10. Step 5 — Your Division Bracket

After completing your 5 placement games, you are automatically assigned to the division that matches your ELO.

Division	ELO Range	What It Means
Bronze	0 – 499	Newer or developing players
Silver	500 – 799	Intermediate skill level
Gold	800 – 1099	Strong competitive players
Diamond	1100+	Elite-level players

Your division may have different names or ELO ranges — check the tournament home page for your specific tournament's divisions.

Once classified, your division's bracket will open and you will be able to:

- 1 Vote on the map and settings for your division.
- 2 See your Round 1 match in your portal.
- 3 Play and report matches to climb the standings.

11. Voting on Division Settings

Before Swiss begins, players in each division vote on their preferred settings.

- 1 Log into your portal.
- 2 On your Dashboard, scroll to the **Vote on Settings** section.
- 3 You will see three categories: **Map**, **Resources**, and **Speed**.
- 4 Click your preferred option for each category.
- 5 Your vote is saved immediately — you can change it before the admin locks settings.
- 6 The leading option in each category is shown to all voters.

Voting matters. The winning option for each category is used for every match in your division for the entire season. Take a moment to vote for what you prefer.

12. Swiss Rounds — How They Work

Swiss is a format where **everyone plays every round** — no one is eliminated until the end.

Round	Who You Play	Why
Round 1	A randomly assigned opponent	First round — no data yet
Rounds 2–7	Someone with the same win-loss record as you	Keeps matches competitive
After 7 rounds	Top 8 advance to playoff	Buchholz score breaks ties

Buchholz score is used as a tiebreaker. It is the sum of all your opponents' wins. A higher Buchholz means you beat stronger opponents, which counts in your favour.

Even if you lose some matches, keep playing. Every win counts toward your standings. You could still make the Top 8 with a good record and strong opponents.

13. Your Tournament Match Lobby

Each Swiss and playoff match has its own auto-generated lobby info shown in your portal.

Info	Example	What It Means
Lobby Name	NA-KINGS-R03-THEVvC LAN	The name of the lobby you create/join
Lobby Password	castle42	Password to enter the lobby
Map	Arabia	The map voted on by your division
Resources	Standard	Starting resources
Speed	Normal	Game speed
Spectator Delay	10 min min	MUST be set in lobby settings

Click **Copy Lobby Info** in your match card to copy all the details to paste into Discord.

Player 1 creates the lobby. Player 2 joins. Your match card tells you which role you have.

14. Reporting Tournament Match Results

Tournament match reporting works identically to placement match reporting:

- 1 After the game, log into your portal.
- 2 Go to Dashboard or My Matches tab.
- 3 Find the match and click **I Won** or **I Lost**.
- 4 Wait for your opponent to confirm.
- 5 When both players agree, the result is auto-confirmed and standings update.

If your opponent does not report within a reasonable time, contact them on Discord. If they are unresponsive, report the issue to the tournament admin.

15. Standings and the Top 8 Playoff

Check your standings in **My Portal** → **Standings**.

The standings show:

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | Your position in your division |
| 2 | Your Swiss record (wins and losses) |
| 3 | Your Buchholz score (tiebreaker) |
| 4 | Your current ELO |
| 5 | A green highlight if you are in the Top 8 playoff zone |
| 6 | A note showing how many spots away you are if outside Top 8 |

If you finish in the top 8 of your division's Swiss bracket, you advance to the **single-elimination playoff**. The playoff runs Quarterfinals → Semifinals → Grand Final.

Win the Grand Final and a champion banner with your name appears on the tournament home page. Your division champion title lasts until the next season.

16. Entry Fees — How to Pay via PayPal

The tournament entry fee is split into two separate PayPal payments:

Fee	Amount	Goes To
Platform Admin Fee	Set by organiser (e.g. \$5)	The platform that runs the tournament software
Prize Pool Fee	Set by host (e.g. \$10)	The prize pool, paid out to division winners

When do you pay?

Placement games are always free. You pay the entry fee **after** your placement games are done and you know which division you are in.

How to pay, step by step:

- 1 Log into your portal. If there's an entry fee, a **Pay Your Entry Fee** section appears on your Dashboard.
- 2 You'll see two cards: **Platform Admin Fee** and **Prize Pool Fee**, each with its own **Pay via PayPal** button.
- 3 Click the first button and complete the PayPal payment for the admin fee.
- 4 Click the second button and complete the PayPal payment for the prize fee.
- 5 Both PayPal links are pre-filled with the correct amount and a note containing your email, the tournament name, and your Discord tag — this is automatic, you don't need to type anything.
- 6 Once both payments are sent, click **"I've Paid Both Fees"** in your portal.
- 7 Your status changes to ■ **Submitted — Awaiting Confirmation**.
- 8 The organiser checks their PayPal account and confirms receipt. Your status then changes to ■ **Received — Can Play**.

You need both fees confirmed as Received before you can play in the paid tournament bracket. Placement games remain free and unaffected by your payment status.

Where to check your payment status:

Go to **My Portal** → **Profile**. Your current status (No Payment Submitted / Submitted / Received) is shown there.

What if you paid but it's still showing Submitted?

The organiser needs to manually check their PayPal account and confirm. This isn't instant — give it some time, and contact the organiser on Discord if it's been more than a day or two.

17. Reporting a Player for Misconduct

If an opponent is behaving badly — no-shows, rude behaviour, cheating — you can report them.

- 1 In your pending match card, find the **Report [Player Name]** button.
- 2 Click it.
- 3 A text box appears. Describe what happened clearly.
- 4 Click **Submit Report**.
- 5 The report goes to the tournament admin for review.

Reason to Report	Examples
No-show	Opponent did not appear for a scheduled match and did not respond on Discord
Cheating	Modified game files, exploiting bugs not allowed by tournament rules
Harassment	Abusive language in Discord or in-game chat
Unsportsmanlike conduct	Lobby manipulation, refusing to follow agreed settings

18. Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
I forgot my password. What do I do?	Contact the tournament organiser or admin. They can reset your password.
My placement match opponent isn't responding.	Message them on Discord. If no response after 48 hours, report a no-show to the admin.
Can I change my timezone after registering?	Contact the admin — they can update your profile.
What if I can't play at the scheduled time?	Coordinate with your opponent on Discord to agree on a different time. As long as both of you agree, you can play any time before the deadline.
I won but my opponent reported a loss for me.	A dispute is created. Save your game recording and send it to the admin when requested.
How is ELO calculated?	Using the standard chess ELO formula. Win against a higher-rated player = more ELO gained. Lose to a lower-rated player = more ELO lost.
What is Buchholz score?	Sum of all your opponents' wins. Higher Buchholz = you beat stronger players = better tiebreaker position.
Can I play in multiple divisions?	No. You are assigned to exactly one division based on your placement ELO.
What if I don't finish all 5 placement games?	You will not be classified and cannot enter a division bracket. Complete all placements before the deadline.
Where do I find the lobby name and password?	In your portal Dashboard or My Matches tab, on the match card for that game.

I paid via PayPal but I still can't enter the bracket.	Make sure you clicked "I've Paid Both Fees" after paying. Then wait for the organiser to confirm receipt in their PayPal account — your status will change from Submitted to Received.
Why do I pay two separate PayPal payments?	One fee goes to the platform that runs the tournament software, the other goes to your tournament's host for the prize pool. Tracking them separately keeps everything transparent.
Can I see the live prize pool before I pay?	Yes — the current prize pool total is shown on the tournament home page and on each division card. It grows as more players' payments are confirmed.
Do I need a PayPal account to pay?	Yes, PayPal is required to send the entry fee payments. If you don't have one, you can create a free account at paypal.com .